The Complete Catechism Kit

Sunday Explained to Kids

The Gospel of Every Sunday · Year B 2026-2027

To understand what we hear at Mass, as a family or in religious ed.



November 29, 2026 to November 21, 2027

For Parents and Catechists

Every Sunday at Mass, a passage from the Gospel is read. For a child, that reading often goes by too fast. This booklet retells, in simple words, the Gospel your child will hear Sunday after Sunday throughout the 2026-2027 liturgical year.

One page for each Sunday, holy day of obligation, and major feast: 58 pages, from the First Sunday of Advent (November 29, 2026) to the Solemnity of Christ the King (November 21, 2027), following the liturgical calendar of the dioceses of the United States (Year B).

What You Will Find on Each Page

- **The Date and the Color**: the date of the Mass and the color of the vestments the priest wears that day
- **The Gospel Told for Kids**: the day's Gospel passage, true to the text and told simply, with one short verse quoted directly from the Bible
- **What Jesus Tells Us**: the message to remember, in a few words
- **The Picture**: to color during or after the reading
- **My Question**: so your child can think and answer in his or her own words
- **This Week as a Family**: a simple activity to do together

A Few Tips

- Read the page with your child on Saturday or Sunday morning, before Mass, so he or she will recognize the Gospel when it is proclaimed.
- In religious ed, use the week's page at the start of class to connect the lesson to Sunday's Mass.
- The reference (for example "Mark 13:33-37") lets you find the full text in a Bible or in the daily readings on the website of the United States Conference of Catholic Bishops (bible.usccb.org).
- In most of the United States, the Ascension is celebrated on Sunday, May 9, 2027. In the ecclesiastical provinces of Boston, Hartford, New York, Omaha, and Philadelphia, it is celebrated on Thursday, May 6, and May 9 is the Seventh Sunday of Easter: use the page that matches your diocese.

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Sunday, November 29, 2026 Color: violet

First Sunday of Advent

Stay Awake!

Gospel: Mark 13:33-37

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is talking with his disciples. He tells them a little story. A man goes away on a trip. Before he leaves, he puts his servants in charge of his house: each one gets a job to do. He asks the gatekeeper to keep watch, which means to stay wide awake and pay attention.

Nobody knows when the master will come back: in the evening, in the middle of the night, when the rooster crows, or in the morning. It would not be good if he found everyone asleep! So Jesus says to his friends, and to all of us: "What I say to you, I say to all: 'Watch!'"

What Jesus Tells Us: During Advent, we get our hearts ready to welcome Jesus, like the gatekeeper who watches for the master to come home.



Color the Advent wreath. Today, color the first candle violet.

My Question

What can you do this week to get your heart ready to welcome Jesus?

This Week as a Family

Light the first candle of the Advent wreath and say a short prayer together.

Sunday, December 6, 2026 Color: violet

Second Sunday of Advent

Prepare the Way of the Lord

Gospel: Mark 1:1-8

The Gospel Told for Kids

Long ago, the prophet Isaiah announced that God would send a messenger to get everything ready for the Lord. Isaiah wrote: "A voice of one crying out in the desert:
'Prepare the way of the Lord,
make straight his paths.'" That messenger is John. He lives in the desert. He wears clothes made of camel's hair and eats locusts and wild honey.

John invites people to be baptized for the forgiveness of their sins. People come to him from all over Judea and from Jerusalem. They admit their sins, and John baptizes them in the Jordan River. John tells them that someone mightier than he is coming after him. John baptizes with water, but the one who is coming will baptize with the Holy Spirit.

What Jesus Tells Us: To welcome Jesus, we get our hearts ready, the way we would clear a straight path for a friend who is coming to visit.



Color John the Baptist by the Jordan River.

My Question

What helps you get your heart ready for Jesus?

This Week as a Family

Light two candles on the Advent wreath. Then take turns saying "I'm sorry" for one small thing from this week.

Tuesday, December 8, 2026 Color: white

The Immaculate Conception of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Mary, Full of Grace

Gospel: Luke 1:26-38

The Gospel Told for Kids

God sends the angel Gabriel to Nazareth, to a young woman named Mary. She is engaged to Joseph. The angel greets her with very special words: "Hail, favored one! The Lord is with you." When we pray the "Hail Mary," we greet her the same way: Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with you.

Mary is troubled by this greeting. The angel tells her not to be afraid, because God is pleased with her. She will have a son, and she will name him Jesus. The Holy Spirit will come upon her, and the child will be called the Son of God. God has filled Mary with his grace and has kept her free from sin from the very first moment of her life. This is what we celebrate today.

What Jesus Tells Us: Mary is full of grace: God prepared her to be the mother of Jesus. She is the patroness of the United States, and she helps us say no to sin and yes to God.



Color Mary, full of grace, with the crown of stars around her head.

My Question

What would you like to ask Mary, our Mother, today?

This Week as a Family

Today is a holy day of obligation: go to Mass together. At home, pray the "Hail Mary" slowly and stop for a moment at the words "full of grace."

Sunday, December 13, 2026 Color: rose

Third Sunday of Advent (Gaudete Sunday)

John Points to the Light

Gospel: John 1:6-8, 19-28

The Gospel Told for Kids

God sends a man named John. The Gospel says about him: "He was not the light, but came to testify to the light." John comes to speak about the light, so that everyone may believe. One day, priests and Levites come from Jerusalem to ask him who he is. John answers very clearly: he is not the Messiah.

They keep asking: then who are you? John answers that he is the voice crying out in the desert, telling everyone to get the road ready for the Lord. Then he says that someone is already standing among them, someone they do not know. He is coming after John, and John is not even worthy to untie the strap of his sandal.

What Jesus Tells Us: John does not talk about himself: he points to Jesus. We can also help others get to know Jesus.



Color the Advent wreath. Today, three candles are lit: the third one is rose, because this is the Sunday of joy.

My Question

How can you point others to Jesus, like John?

This Week as a Family

Light the rose candle on the Advent wreath and share one happy moment from your week.

Sunday, December 20, 2026 Color: violet

Fourth Sunday of Advent

Mary Says Yes to God

Gospel: Luke 1:26-38

The Gospel Told for Kids

God sends the angel Gabriel to Nazareth, to a young woman named Mary, who is engaged to Joseph. The angel greets her and tells her that the Lord is with her. Mary is very troubled. The angel tells her not to be afraid: she will have a son, and she will name him Jesus. He will be great and will be called Son of the Most High.

Mary asks how this can happen. The angel answers that the Holy Spirit will come upon her, and the child will be called the Son of God, because nothing is impossible for God. Then Mary gives her answer: "Behold, I am the handmaid of the Lord. May it be done to me according to your word."

What Jesus Tells Us: Mary trusts God and says yes to him. We can also say yes to what God asks of us.



Color the angel Gabriel and Mary praying.

My Question

What can you say yes to this week to make God happy?

This Week as a Family

Light all four candles on the Advent wreath and pray the "Hail Mary" together.

Friday, December 25, 2026 Color: white

Christmas · The Nativity of the Lord

Jesus Is Born in Bethlehem

Gospel: Luke 2:1-14

The Gospel Told for Kids

The emperor orders everyone to go to their family's hometown to be counted. So Joseph leaves Nazareth with Mary, who is expecting a baby, and travels to Bethlehem, the city of David. There, Mary gives birth to her son. She wraps him in swaddling clothes and lays him in a manger, because there is no room for them in the inn.

That night, out in the fields, shepherds are watching over their flocks. An angel appears to them, and the light of God shines all around them. The angel says: "Do not be afraid; for behold, I proclaim to you good news of great joy that will be for all the people. For today in the city of David a savior has been born for you who is Messiah and Lord." Then a whole crowd of angels sings praise to God.

What Jesus Tells Us: God made himself very small to come close to us. Jesus is the great joy of Christmas for everyone.



Color Jesus in the manger, with Mary and Joseph.

My Question

What would you like to say to Jesus on his birthday?

This Week as a Family

In front of the Nativity scene, sing a Christmas carol together and thank God for Jesus.

Sunday, December 27, 2026 Color: white

The Holy Family of Jesus, Mary and Joseph

Jesus Is Presented in the Temple

Gospel: Luke 2:22-40

The Gospel Told for Kids

Mary and Joseph take Baby Jesus to the Temple in Jerusalem to present him to the Lord, as the Law of Moses requires. They bring two small birds as an offering. In the Temple there is Simeon, a good and holy man who is waiting for the Savior. He takes the child in his arms and thanks God: now his eyes have seen the salvation God prepared, a light for all the peoples.

There is also Anna, a very old woman who prays in the Temple day and night. She thanks God and speaks about the child to everyone. Then the family goes home to Nazareth. And the Gospel tells us: "The child grew and became strong, filled with wisdom; and the favor of God was upon him."

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus grew up in a family, surrounded by love. God blesses our families.



Color Simeon holding Jesus in his arms, with Mary, Joseph, and Anna.

My Question

Which person in your family do you want to thank God for?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Before a meal, let each person thank God for someone else in the family.

Friday, January 1, 2027 Color: white

Mary, the Holy Mother of God

Mary Keeps It All in Her Heart

Gospel: Luke 2:16-21

The Gospel Told for Kids

The shepherds hurry to Bethlehem, just as the angel told them. There they find Mary and Joseph, and the baby lying in the manger. They tell everyone what the angel said about this child, and all who hear it are amazed. Mary listens to everything. The Gospel tells us: "And Mary kept all these things, reflecting on them in her heart."

Then the shepherds go back to their flocks, praising God for all they have heard and seen. Eight days later, the baby receives his name: Jesus, the name the angel gave him even before he was born.

What Jesus Tells Us: Mary is the mother of Jesus, and Jesus is the Son of God: that is why we call her the Mother of God. We begin the new year with her.



Color Mary, Joseph, and baby Jesus in the manger.

My Question

What would you like to keep in your heart this new year, like Mary?

This Week as a Family

Today is a holy day of obligation: go to Mass together, then ask Mary to watch over your family all year long.

Sunday, January 3, 2027 Color: white

The Epiphany of the Lord

The Wise Men Follow the Star

Gospel: Matthew 2:1-12

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is born in Bethlehem. Wise Men from the East arrive in Jerusalem and ask: "Where is the newborn king of the Jews? We saw his star at its rising and have come to do him homage." King Herod is worried. He sends them to Bethlehem and asks them to come back and tell him where the child is.

The star goes ahead of the Wise Men and stops over the place where the child is. They are filled with joy! They see the child with Mary, his mother, and they bow down to honor him. They offer him gifts of gold, frankincense, and myrrh. Then, warned in a dream, they go home by another way.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus came for all the peoples of the earth. Like the Wise Men, we can offer him the very best we have.



Color the Wise Men offering their gifts to Jesus, and the star that guided them.

My Question

What gift would you like to give to Jesus?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Bless your home with chalk: write 20 + C + M + B + 27 above your front door and pray together for children all over the world.

Sunday, January 10, 2027 Color: white

The Baptism of the Lord

You Are My Beloved Son

Gospel: Mark 1:7-11

The Gospel Told for Kids

John the Baptist announces that someone mightier than he is coming after him. John says he is not even worthy to bend down and untie his sandals. John baptizes with water, but the one who is coming will baptize with the Holy Spirit.

One day, Jesus comes from Nazareth in Galilee, and John baptizes him in the Jordan River. As Jesus comes up out of the water, he sees the heavens open and the Spirit coming down upon him like a dove. And a voice comes from heaven: "You are my beloved Son; with you I am well pleased."

What Jesus Tells Us: On the day of our Baptism, we too became God's beloved children.



Color Jesus in the Jordan River, John the Baptist, and the dove of the Holy Spirit.

My Question

Do you know the year and the church where you were baptized?

This Week as a Family

Look together at the photos or the candle from your child's Baptism, and tell him or her about that day.

Sunday, January 17, 2027 Color: green

Second Sunday in Ordinary Time

Come, and You Will See

Gospel: John 1:35-42

The Gospel Told for Kids

John the Baptist is standing with two of his disciples. He sees Jesus walking by and calls him the Lamb of God. The two disciples start to follow Jesus. Jesus turns around and asks them what they are looking for. They ask him where he is staying. Jesus says to them: "Come, and you will see." So they go with him and stay with him all that day.

One of the two is named Andrew. He goes to find his brother Simon and tells him that they have found the Messiah! He brings Simon to Jesus. Jesus looks at him and gives him a new name: from now on, he will be called Peter.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus invites us to come close to him, and like Andrew, we can invite others to know him.



Color John the Baptist pointing to Jesus, with the lamb at his feet.

My Question

Who would you like to tell about Jesus?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Spend a moment with Jesus as a family: light a candle and stay quiet for one minute and talk to him in your heart.

Sunday, January 24, 2027 Color: green

Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Calls the Fishermen

Gospel: Mark 1:14-20

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus goes to Galilee and announces the Good News of God: the kingdom of God is very near! He asks everyone to turn their hearts back to God and to believe in the Gospel. By the Sea of Galilee, he sees Simon and his brother Andrew casting their nets into the sea: they are fishermen.

Jesus says to them: "Come after me, and I will make you fishers of men." Right away, they leave their nets and follow him. A little farther on, Jesus sees James and his brother John in their boat, mending their nets. He calls them, and they too leave everything to go with him.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus calls each one of us to follow him and to be his friend.



Color Jesus calling Simon and Andrew, with their net and their boat.

My Question

What does "following Jesus" mean to you?

This Week as a Family

Pray for all the people Jesus calls today: priests, religious sisters and brothers, catechists...

Sunday, January 31, 2027 Color: green

Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Speaks With Authority

Gospel: Mark 1:21-28

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus and his disciples arrive in Capernaum. On the Sabbath, Jesus goes into the synagogue and teaches. Mark tells us: "The people were astonished at his teaching, for he taught them as one having authority and not as the scribes."

In the synagogue there is a man troubled by an evil spirit, and he starts to shout. Jesus firmly orders the evil spirit to be quiet and to come out of the man. The evil spirit leaves, and the man is set free. Everyone is amazed and asks what this new teaching is: even the evil spirits obey him! And news about Jesus spreads all through Galilee.

What Jesus Tells Us: The word of Jesus is stronger than any evil. We can trust him.



Color Jesus teaching and the people listening to him.

My Question

Which words of Jesus do you know by heart?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Read one short sentence from the Gospel together every evening this week.

Sunday, February 7, 2027 Color: green

Fifth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Heals and Prays

Gospel: Mark 1:29-39

The Gospel Told for Kids

After leaving the synagogue, Jesus goes to the house of Simon and Andrew. Simon's mother-in-law is in bed with a fever. Jesus comes close, takes her by the hand, and helps her up. The fever leaves her, and she begins to serve them. That evening, the whole town gathers at the door, and Jesus heals many people who are sick.

Then Mark tells us: "Rising very early before dawn, he left and went off to a deserted place, where he prayed." His friends go looking for him and tell him that everyone is searching for him. Jesus answers that they must go on to the nearby villages, so that he can preach the Good News there too.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus takes care of those who suffer, and he also takes time to pray to his Father.



Color Jesus taking the hand of Simon's mother-in-law and helping her up.

My Question

Is there someone who is sick that you want to pray for?

This Week as a Family

Check on someone who is sick or alone (a phone call, a drawing, a visit).

Wednesday, February 10, 2027 Color: violet

Ash Wednesday

In Secret

Gospel: Matthew 6:1-6, 16-18

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus teaches his disciples not to do good things just so other people will see them. When you give to people who are poor, there is no need to tell everyone: do it quietly, and your Father, who sees what is hidden, will reward you.

Jesus also says: "But when you pray, go to your inner room, close the door, and pray to your Father in secret. And your Father who sees in secret will repay you." And when you fast, do not put on a sad face so that people will notice: wash your face, and only your Father will know.

What Jesus Tells Us: During Lent, we share, we pray, and we make sacrifices, not to be seen, but for God, who loves us.



Color the children receiving ashes at the beginning of Lent.

My Question

What secret sacrifice can you make during Lent?

This Week as a Family

Make a Lenten rice bowl together and fill it with coins during Lent to share with people in need.

Sunday, February 14, 2027 Color: violet

First Sunday of Lent

Jesus in the Desert

Gospel: Mark 1:12-15

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus has just been baptized. The Spirit leads him out into the desert. He stays there for forty days, the same number of days as our Lent. There he is tempted by Satan. He lives among the wild animals, and the angels take care of him.

Later, after John the Baptist is arrested, Jesus goes to Galilee to announce the Good News of God. He says: "This is the time of fulfillment. The kingdom of God is at hand. Repent, and believe in the gospel." To repent means to turn our hearts back toward God.

What Jesus Tells Us: During the forty days of Lent, Jesus helps us turn our hearts toward God.



Color Jesus praying in the desert.

My Question

What helps you stay close to God when things are hard?

This Week as a Family

Choose one Lenten sacrifice for the whole family (less screen time, a kind act, a prayer). On a Friday, pray the Stations of the Cross at your parish.

Sunday, February 21, 2027 Color: violet

Second Sunday of Lent

Jesus Is Transfigured

Gospel: Mark 9:2-10

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus takes Peter, James, and John up a high mountain. There, in front of them, he is changed: his clothes become dazzling white. Moses and Elijah appear and talk with Jesus. Peter says it is good for them to be there, and he offers to make three tents. He hardly knows what to say, because the disciples are so frightened.

A cloud covers them, and a voice comes from the cloud: "This is my beloved Son. Listen to him." Suddenly, they see no one but Jesus. On the way down the mountain, Jesus asks them not to tell anyone until he has risen from the dead.

What Jesus Tells Us: God tells us to listen to Jesus, his beloved Son.



Color Jesus shining with light, with Moses, Elijah, and the three disciples.

My Question

When do you take time to listen to Jesus?

This Week as a Family

Read this Sunday's Gospel together and let each person share one sentence they liked.

Sunday, February 28, 2027 Color: violet

Third Sunday of Lent

My Father's House

Gospel: John 2:13-25

The Gospel Told for Kids

The feast of Passover is near. Jesus goes up to the Temple in Jerusalem. There he finds people selling oxen, sheep, and doves, and money changers sitting at their tables. Jesus sends them all out of the Temple, and to those selling doves he says: "Take these out of here, and stop making my Father's house a marketplace."

Some people ask him what sign he can show them for acting this way. Jesus answers that if this temple is destroyed, he will raise it up in three days. He is talking about his own body. Later, when Jesus is raised from the dead, his disciples remember these words, and they believe.

What Jesus Tells Us: The church is God's house, a place to pray. Our hearts can be a home for God too.



Color Jesus in front of the Temple, his Father's house.

My Question

How do you behave when you walk into a church?

This Week as a Family

Stop by a church together this week, even for a few minutes, to pray in silence.

Sunday, March 7, 2027 Color: violet

Fourth Sunday of Lent (Laetare Sunday)

God So Loved the World

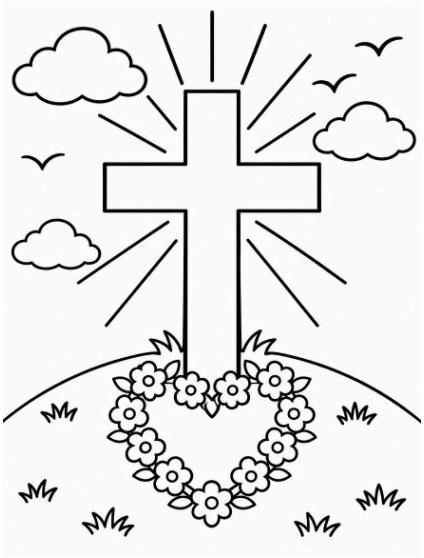
Gospel: John 3:14-21

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is talking with Nicodemus. He reminds him of the serpent that Moses lifted up in the desert: in the same way, the Son of Man must be lifted up, so that everyone who believes in him may have eternal life. Then come these famous words: "For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, so that everyone who believes in him might not perish but might have eternal life."

God did not send his Son into the world to condemn the world, but so that the world might be saved through him. The light has come into the world. Whoever does what is true and good comes to the light.

What Jesus Tells Us: God loves us so much that he gave us Jesus. With him, we walk in the light.



Color the shining cross and the heart of flowers: God so loved the world!

My Question

How do you know that God loves you?

This Week as a Family

Write "God so loved the world" on a sheet of paper and hang it up at home.

Sunday, March 14, 2027 Color: violet

Fifth Sunday of Lent

The Grain of Wheat

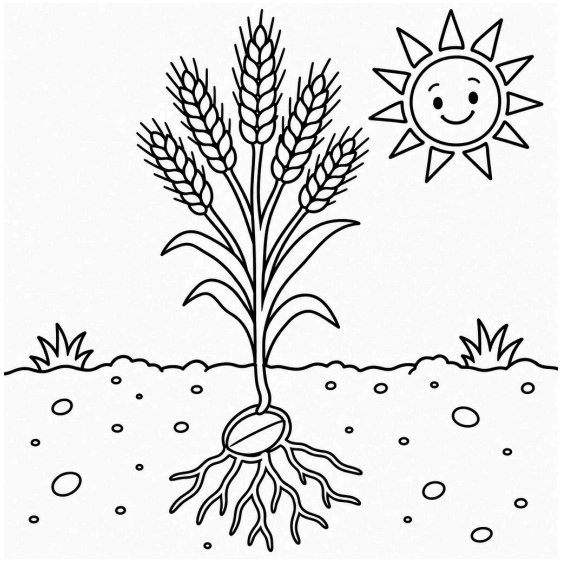
Gospel: John 12:20-33

The Gospel Told for Kids

During the feast of Passover, some Greeks come to Philip and tell him that they would like to see Jesus. Philip and Andrew go and tell Jesus. Jesus answers with an example from the fields: "... unless a grain of wheat falls to the ground and dies, it remains just a grain of wheat; but if it dies, it produces much fruit."

Jesus is telling them that he is going to give his life. He also says that whoever wants to serve him must follow him. Then he prays to his Father and asks him to glorify his name, and a voice answers from heaven. Jesus says that when he is lifted up from the earth, he will draw everyone to himself.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus gives his life out of love, like the grain that becomes a tall stalk of wheat. When we give our time and our love, we bear fruit too.



Color the little grain in the ground and the tall stalk of wheat that has grown.

My Question

What can you give to others to bear fruit, like the grain of wheat?

This Week as a Family

Plant a few seeds in a pot and watch them grow until Easter.

Sunday, March 21, 2027 Color: red

Palm Sunday of the Passion of the Lord

Jesus Enters Jerusalem

Gospel: Mark 11:1-10

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is near Jerusalem. He sends two disciples to the village ahead: there they will find a young donkey tied up. They must untie it and bring it to him. If anyone asks why, they should say that the Master needs it. The disciples find the colt, just as Jesus said.

They put their cloaks on the colt, and Jesus sits on it. Many people spread their cloaks on the road, and others spread leafy branches cut from the fields. Everyone cries out: "Hosanna! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!"

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is the king God sends us. We welcome him with joy, like the crowd in Jerusalem.



Color Jesus on the little donkey and the children waving palm branches.

My Question

If you had been there, what would you have shouted to Jesus?

This Week as a Family

Put the palm blessed at Mass behind a crucifix or a holy card at home, and begin Holy Week together.

Sunday, March 28, 2027 Color: white

Easter Sunday · The Resurrection of the Lord

The Tomb Is Empty!

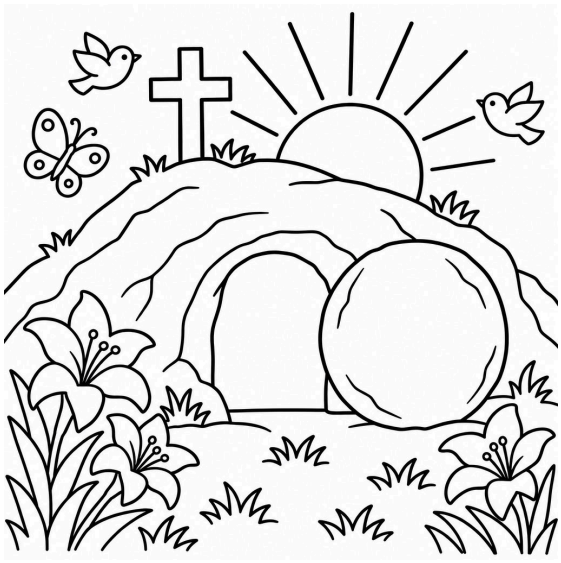
Gospel: John 20:1-9

The Gospel Told for Kids

On the first day of the week, very early, while it is still dark, Mary Magdalene goes to the tomb of Jesus. She sees that the stone has been taken away. She runs to tell Peter and the other disciple, the one Jesus loved: someone has taken the Lord from the tomb, and they do not know where he is!

The two disciples run to the tomb. The other disciple gets there first, but he waits outside. Peter goes in and sees the burial cloths lying there. And then: "Then the other disciple also went in, the one who had arrived at the tomb first, and he saw and believed." Until then, the disciples had not yet understood the Scripture that said Jesus had to rise from the dead.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is alive! God's love is stronger than death. Alleluia!



Color the empty tomb, the Easter morning sun, and the flowers.

My Question

How will you share the joy of Easter with someone?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Decorate the Easter table with flowers and sing "Alleluia" together.

Sunday, April 4, 2027 Color: white

Second Sunday of Easter (Divine Mercy Sunday)

Thomas Believes in Jesus

Gospel: John 20:19-31

The Gospel Told for Kids

On the evening of Easter Sunday, the disciples are in a house with the doors locked, because they are afraid. Suddenly Jesus is there, in the middle of them! He says, "Peace be with you." He shows them his hands and his side. The disciples are filled with joy. Jesus breathes on them and gives them the Holy Spirit.

But Thomas is not there. He tells the others that he will not believe unless he sees for himself. A week later, Jesus comes back, and this time Thomas is with them. Jesus invites him to look at his hands and to believe. Thomas cries out: "My Lord and my God!" Jesus says that those who believe without having seen are blessed.

What Jesus Tells Us: We cannot see Jesus with our eyes, but we can believe in him with all our heart: he is alive!



Color the risen Jesus, and Thomas kneeling in front of him.

My Question

Like Thomas, what would you like to say to the risen Jesus?

This Week as a Family

Today is Divine Mercy Sunday. This evening, pray the words of Thomas together, slowly, in front of a picture of Jesus.

Sunday, April 11, 2027 Color: white

Third Sunday of Easter

Jesus Eats With His Friends

Gospel: Luke 24:35-48

The Gospel Told for Kids

Two disciples are telling the Apostles how they recognized Jesus when he broke the bread. While they are still talking, Jesus is standing right there among them, and he says, "Peace be with you." They are terrified: they think they are seeing a ghost.

Jesus asks them why they are so troubled, and he says: "Look at my hands and my feet, that it is I myself. Touch me and see, because a ghost does not have flesh and bones as you can see I have." Then he asks for something to eat. They give him a piece of grilled fish, and he eats it in front of them. Jesus helps them understand the Scriptures. He tells them that they will be his witnesses: they will go and announce God's forgiveness to all nations.

What Jesus Tells Us: The risen Jesus is truly alive, and he sends us to tell everyone that God forgives.



Color the risen Jesus at the table with his friends.

My Question

Who would you like to tell that Jesus is alive?

This Week as a Family

At dinner, make room for Jesus at your table by saying grace together.

Sunday, April 18, 2027 Color: white

Fourth Sunday of Easter

The Good Shepherd

Gospel: John 10:11-18

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus tells his disciples: "I am the good shepherd. A good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." A good shepherd loves his sheep. A hired man, who is only paid to watch them, does not really care about them: when the wolf comes, he runs away, and the flock is scattered.

Jesus knows each one of his sheep, and his sheep know him. He also has other sheep that are not yet in his sheepfold. They will listen to his voice, and there will be one flock with one shepherd. Jesus says that no one takes his life from him: he gives it himself, out of love.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is my Good Shepherd: he knows me by name and takes care of me.



Color Jesus, the Good Shepherd, with his sheep.

My Question

How can you listen to the voice of Jesus?

This Week as a Family

This week, pray for your pastor and for the priests of your parish, who are shepherds of the community.

Sunday, April 25, 2027 Color: white

Fifth Sunday of Easter

The Vine and the Branches

Gospel: John 15:1-8

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus tells his disciples that he is the true vine and that his Father is the one who takes care of the vineyard. A branch cannot grow grapes all by itself: it has to stay attached to the vine. The Father trims the branches so that they bear even more fruit.

Then Jesus explains: "I am the vine, you are the branches. Whoever remains in me and I in him will bear much fruit, because without me you can do nothing." A branch that is cut off from the vine dries up. But a branch that stays on the vine is full of grapes. When we bear much fruit, we give glory to the Father.

What Jesus Tells Us: If I stay close to Jesus, like a branch on the vine, I can bear beautiful fruits of love.



Color Jesus, the vine with its bunches of grapes, and the children.

My Question

What beautiful fruit of love can you give this week?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Each evening, name together one "fruit" of the day: a kind act, a word of forgiveness, a smile.

Sunday, May 2, 2027 Color: white

Sixth Sunday of Easter

Love One Another

Gospel: John 15:9-17

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus speaks to his disciples. He tells them that he loves them just as the Father loves him, and he asks them to stay in his love. He tells them all this because he wants them to be filled with his joy.

Then he gives them his commandment: "This is my commandment: love one another as I love you." No one has a greater love than the one who gives his life for his friends. Jesus no longer calls them servants: he calls them his friends. He is the one who chose them, so that they will go out and bear fruit, fruit that lasts.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus calls me his friend. He asks me to love others the way he loves me.



Color Jesus surrounded by his friends.

My Question

Who can you love a little more this week, as Jesus asks?

This Week as a Family

Together, choose someone who is lonely and do something this week to make that person happy.

Sunday, May 9, 2027 Color: white

The Ascension of the Lord

Jesus Goes Up to Heaven

Gospel: Mark 16:15-20

The Gospel Told for Kids

The risen Jesus appears to the eleven Apostles. He tells them: "Go into the whole world and proclaim the gospel to every creature." God will save those who believe and are baptized. Jesus says that signs will go with those who believe: they will speak new languages, and they will put their hands on sick people, who will get better.

When Jesus has finished speaking to them, he is lifted up into heaven, and he sits at the right hand of God. Then the Apostles set out and announce the Good News everywhere in the world. And the Lord helps them in all their work.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is with his Father, and he stays with us when we share his Good News.



Color Jesus going up to heaven, and his friends watching him.

My Question

How can you, too, talk about Jesus to the people around you?

This Week as a Family

In some dioceses, the Ascension is celebrated on Thursday, May 6. Look up at the sky together and thank Jesus, who watches over us from his Father's side.

Sunday, May 9, 2027 Color: white

Seventh Sunday of Easter (where the Ascension was celebrated on Thursday, May 6)

Jesus Prays for His Friends

Gospel: John 17:11b-19

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus raises his eyes to heaven and prays to his Father for his disciples. He asks the Father to keep them united, as he and the Father are united. When he was with them, Jesus watched over them and kept them safe.

Now Jesus is going back to his Father. He prays that his friends will be filled with his joy. He says to his Father: "I do not ask that you take them out of the world but that you keep them from the evil one." Jesus has given them the word of God, and he sends them into the world, just as the Father sent him.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus prays for me. I can pray for others too.



Color the child who is praying, like Jesus praying for his friends.

My Question

Who would you like to pray for today?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Each evening, let everyone name one person to pray for. Today is Mother's Day: start with your mom.

Sunday, May 16, 2027 Color: red

Pentecost Sunday

Jesus Promises the Holy Spirit

Gospel: John 15:26-27; 16:12-15

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is talking with his disciples. He promises to send them a helper from his Father: "When the Advocate comes whom I will send you from the Father, the Spirit of truth that proceeds from the Father, he will testify to me." The Advocate is the Holy Spirit, who stays by our side. The disciples will speak about Jesus too, because they have been with him from the very beginning.

Jesus tells them that he still has many things to say to them, but they cannot understand everything yet. When the Spirit comes, he will lead them to the whole truth. He will make known to them what comes from Jesus and what is going to happen. For everything that belongs to the Father also belongs to Jesus.

What Jesus Tells Us: The Holy Spirit is the gift of Jesus: he helps me understand his Word and live it.



Color Mary and the Apostles receiving the Holy Spirit, and the dove.

My Question

What would you like to ask the Holy Spirit to help you with?

This Week as a Family

Before your Sunday meal, say together: "Come, Holy Spirit!"

Sunday, May 23, 2027 Color: white

The Most Holy Trinity

Go, Make Disciples!

Gospel: Matthew 28:16-20

The Gospel Told for Kids

The eleven disciples go to Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus told them to meet him. When they see him, they bow down before him, but some of them still have doubts.

Jesus comes close to them. He tells them that all power in heaven and on earth has been given to him, and he says: "Go, therefore, and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the holy Spirit..." He asks them to teach everyone to live the way he taught them. Then he makes them a wonderful promise: he will be with them every day, until the end of the world.

What Jesus Tells Us: On the day of my Baptism, I was baptized in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Jesus is with me every day.



Color the baby's Baptism and the dove of the Holy Spirit.

My Question

Can you make the Sign of the Cross while saying the three names?

This Week as a Family

Together, make a beautiful Sign of the Cross, slowly, at the beginning and at the end of your prayer.

Sunday, May 30, 2027 Color: white

The Most Holy Body and Blood of Christ (Corpus Christi)

This Is My Body

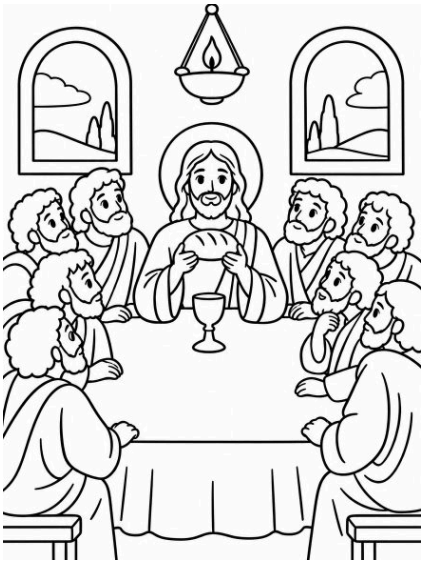
Gospel: Mark 14:12-16, 22-26

The Gospel Told for Kids

It is the first day of the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the bread made without yeast. The disciples ask Jesus where they should get the Passover meal ready. Jesus sends two of them into the city. They find everything just as he said: a large room upstairs, ready for the meal.

During the meal, Jesus takes some bread. He blesses it, breaks it, and shares it with his friends, saying: "Take it; this is my body." Then he takes a cup, gives thanks, and gives it to them, and they all drink from it. Jesus tells them that this is his blood of the covenant. Afterward, they sing a hymn and go out to the Mount of Olives.

What Jesus Tells Us: At every Mass, Jesus gives himself to us in the consecrated bread and wine.



Color Jesus and his friends around the table, with the bread and the cup.

My Question

What does the priest do at Mass to remember this meal of Jesus?

This Week as a Family

At Mass, watch together for the moment when the priest lifts up the host and the chalice.

Sunday, June 6, 2027 Color: green

Tenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Family of Jesus

Gospel: Mark 3:20-35

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus comes home, and the crowd is so big that they cannot even eat. Some people say that he is out of his mind. Some teachers of the law even say that he drives out evil with the power of evil. Jesus answers them with a comparison: a family that fights against itself cannot stay standing.

Then his mother and his relatives arrive. They stay outside and send someone to call him. People tell Jesus that his family is looking for him. Jesus looks at the people sitting in a circle around him and says that these people are his family: "...whoever does the will of God is my brother and sister and mother."

What Jesus Tells Us: When I try to do what God wants, I am part of the big family of Jesus.



Color Jesus surrounded by his big family: all those who listen to him.

My Question

What can you do this week to do what God asks?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Pray together for a family in your parish or in your neighborhood.

Sunday, June 13, 2027 Color: green

Eleventh Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Tiny Seed

Gospel: Mark 4:26-34

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus uses stories to talk about God's kingdom. A man scatters seeds on the ground. Whether he is sleeping or awake, the seeds sprout and grow, and he does not know how. First the earth gives a green shoot, then the ear, then the full grain of wheat. When the grain is ripe, it is harvest time.

Jesus also compares God's kingdom to a tiny seed: "It is like a mustard seed that, when it is sown in the ground, is the smallest of all the seeds on the earth." But once it is planted, it grows bigger than all the other plants in the garden. It puts out long branches, and the birds come and make their nests in its shade.

What Jesus Tells Us: A small act of love can grow very big: God makes it grow.



Color the big tree, the birds in their nests, and the seed being planted.

My Question

What little seed of love can you plant this week?

This Week as a Family

Plant a seed in a pot together and watch it grow week after week.

Sunday, June 20, 2027 Color: green

Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Calms the Storm

Gospel: Mark 4:35-41

The Gospel Told for Kids

In the evening, Jesus tells his disciples that they will cross to the other side of the lake. They get into the boat. But a big storm comes up. The waves crash into the boat, and it starts to fill with water. Jesus is asleep in the back, on a cushion.

The disciples wake him up: they are afraid they are going to drown! Jesus gets up. He scolds the wind and says to the sea: "Quiet! Be still!" The wind stops, and everything becomes calm. Jesus asks them why they are so afraid. The disciples are amazed, and they wonder who Jesus really is, since even the wind and the sea obey him.

What Jesus Tells Us: When I am afraid, I can call on Jesus: he is with me in the boat.



Color Jesus calming the storm, and his friends in the boat.

My Question

When you are afraid, what can you say to Jesus?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Tell each other about a time you were afraid, and give it to Jesus together in prayer. Today is Father's Day: thank God for your dad.

Sunday, June 27, 2027 Color: green

Thirteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Little Girl, Get Up!

Gospel: Mark 5:21-43

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jairus, a leader of the synagogue, begs Jesus to come: his little daughter is very sick. Jesus goes with him. On the way, a woman who has been sick for twelve years touches his cloak, and she is healed. Jesus tells her that her faith has saved her, and that she can go in peace.

Then people arrive with sad news: Jairus' daughter has died. Jesus tells her father not to be afraid, but just to believe. At the house, everyone is crying. Jesus says that the child is not dead: she is asleep. He goes in with the father, the mother, and three disciples. He takes the little girl by the hand and says to her: "Little girl, I say to you, arise!" At once she gets up and walks around. She is twelve years old. Jesus tells them to give her something to eat.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is stronger than death. He tells me too: don't be afraid, just believe.



Color Jesus taking the hand of the daughter of Jairus, and her happy parents.

My Question

Which sick person would you like to pray for?

This Week as a Family

Pray together for a sick person you know, and find out how that person is doing.

Sunday, July 4, 2027 Color: green

Fourteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus in His Hometown

Gospel: Mark 6:1-6

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus goes back to his hometown with his disciples. On the Sabbath, he teaches in the synagogue. Many people are amazed, and they wonder where all his wisdom comes from. After all, they know him: he is the carpenter, the son of Mary! They are shocked, and they do not believe in him.

Jesus tells them: "A prophet is not without honor except in his native place and among his own kin and in his own house." There, he can hardly do any miracles: he only heals a few sick people by laying his hands on them. He is amazed that they have so little faith. Then he goes around to the villages nearby to teach.

What Jesus Tells Us: I open my heart to Jesus, even when I think I already know everything about him.



Color Jesus teaching, and the people listening to him.

My Question

How can you listen well to Jesus when the Gospel is read at Mass?

This Week as a Family

Read the Sunday Gospel together before Mass, then talk about it on the way home.

Sunday, July 11, 2027 Color: green

Fifteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sent Out Two by Two

Gospel: Mark 6:7-13

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus calls the Twelve and sends them on a mission, two by two. He gives them power over evil spirits. The Gospel tells us: "He instructed them to take nothing for the journey but a walking stick —no food, no sack, no money in their belts." They can wear sandals, but they must not take a second tunic.

Jesus tells them that when a family welcomes them into its house, they should stay there until they leave that town. If people refuse to listen to them, they should go on somewhere else. So the Apostles set out. They call people to change their lives. They drive out evil spirits, and they anoint many sick people with oil and heal them.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus counts on me and on my friends to bring his Good News, with a light heart.



Color the two Apostles setting out with their walking sticks, and Jesus blessing them.

My Question

Who could you do a good deed with this week?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Visit someone or help someone out, with two or more of you together.

Sunday, July 18, 2027 Color: green

Sixteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Rest a While

Gospel: Mark 6:30-34

The Gospel Told for Kids

The Apostles come back from their mission. They tell Jesus everything they have done and taught. So many people are coming and going that they do not even have time to eat. Jesus says to them: "Come away by yourselves to a deserted place and rest a while."

They leave in the boat for a quiet place. But people see them going. They run there on foot and arrive first! When Jesus steps out of the boat, he sees the huge crowd. He is full of compassion for them, because they are like sheep that have no shepherd. So he takes the time to teach them many things.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus takes care of us like a shepherd: he gives us rest and his Word.



Color Jesus, the shepherd full of compassion, with his sheep.

My Question

When do you take a quiet moment to be with Jesus?

This Week as a Family

This week, take some real time to rest together, without screens, and end it with a prayer.

Sunday, July 25, 2027 Color: green

Seventeenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Feeds the Five Thousand

Gospel: John 6:1-15

The Gospel Told for Kids

A large crowd follows Jesus. He goes up the mountain with his disciples. Jesus asks Philip where they can buy enough bread for all these people to eat. Philip answers that even a lot of money would not be enough. Then Andrew says: "There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish; but what good are these for so many?"

Jesus has the people sit down on the grass. There are about five thousand of them. He takes the loaves, gives thanks, and hands them out, and he gives them fish too. Everyone eats as much as they want. With the pieces that are left over, the disciples fill twelve baskets!

What Jesus Tells Us: Like the boy, I can give the little I have: Jesus makes something great out of it.



Color Jesus, the boy who brings the bread, and the baskets full to the top.

My Question

What could you share with others this week?

This Week as a Family

Together, fill a small bag of food for your parish food pantry or for someone in need.

Sunday, August 1, 2027 Color: green

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus, the Bread of Life

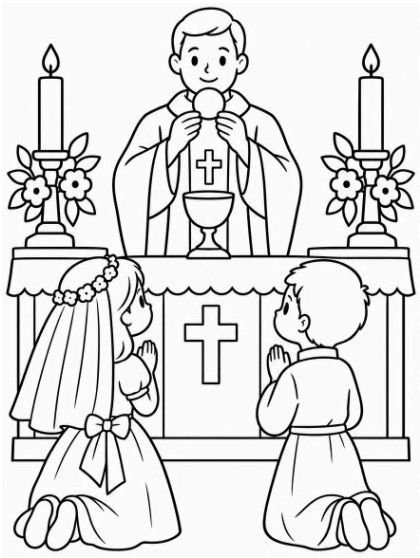
Gospel: John 6:24-35

The Gospel Told for Kids

The crowd is looking for Jesus. The people get into boats and go to Capernaum, and they find him on the other side of the lake. Jesus explains that they are looking for him because they ate the bread and had all they wanted. But he tells them about another kind of food, one that does not spoil and that gives eternal life.

The people remember that long ago, in the desert, their ancestors ate manna, a bread that came from heaven. Jesus answers that it is his Father who gives the true bread from heaven. So they ask him to give them this bread always. Jesus says to them: "I am the bread of life; whoever comes to me will never hunger, and whoever believes in me will never thirst."

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is the bread that feeds our hearts: when we come to him, he gives us his life.



Color the priest showing the host at Mass: Jesus, the bread of life, gives himself to us.

My Question

What is your heart hungry for: joy, peace, friendship? Tell Jesus.

This Week as a Family

Before a meal this week, thank Jesus together for the bread on the table and for the bread of life.

Sunday, August 8, 2027 Color: green

Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Living Bread

Gospel: John 6:41-51

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus has said that he is the bread that came down from heaven. Some people are not happy, and they grumble among themselves. They know Joseph, his father, and they know his mother: how can he say that he came down from heaven? Jesus tells them to stop grumbling. He explains that it is the Father who draws people to him.

Jesus adds that whoever believes has eternal life. Long ago, in the desert, their ancestors ate the manna, and still they died. But Jesus says: "I am the living bread that came down from heaven; whoever eats this bread will live forever..." And the bread he will give is his own flesh, given for the life of the world.

What Jesus Tells Us: At Mass, in the host, Jesus gives himself to us as the living bread.



Color the chalice and the host, the bread of the Mass, with the wheat and the grapes.

My Question

When you go to Mass, how can you say thank you to Jesus, who gives himself to us?

This Week as a Family

At Sunday Mass, when the priest raises the host, whisper together: "Thank you, Jesus."

Sunday, August 15, 2027 Color: white

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Mary Sings for Joy

Gospel: Luke 1:39-56

The Gospel Told for Kids

Mary sets out in a hurry for a town in the hill country of Judah. She goes into the house of Zechariah and greets Elizabeth, who is expecting a baby. As soon as Elizabeth hears Mary's greeting, the baby leaps inside her. Filled with the Holy Spirit, Elizabeth cries out that Mary is blessed among women, and that the child Mary is carrying is blessed too.

Then Mary sings with joy: "My soul proclaims the greatness of the Lord; my spirit rejoices in God my savior." God has done wonderful things for her. She sings that God raises up the humble, gives good things to the hungry, and remembers his love, as he promised Abraham. Mary stays with Elizabeth about three months, and then she goes back home.

What Jesus Tells Us: Today we celebrate Mary, taken body and soul into the joy of heaven. With her, let's sing about the wonderful things God does.



Color Mary and Elizabeth, so happy to see each other.

My Question

What wonderful thing in your life do you want to thank God for, like Mary?

This Week as a Family

Visit a family member or a neighbor who lives alone, the way Mary went to visit Elizabeth.

Sunday, August 22, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-first Sunday in Ordinary Time

Peter Stays With Jesus

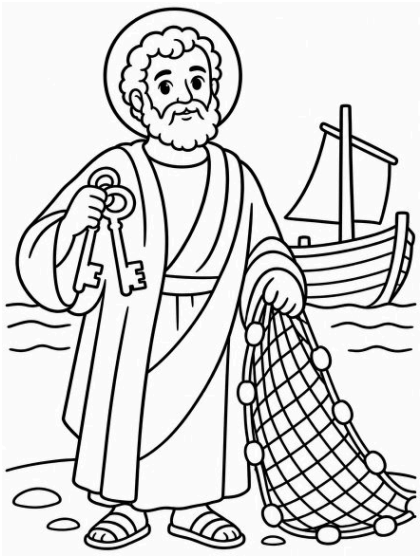
Gospel: John 6:60-69

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus has explained that he is the bread of life. Many of his disciples find his words too hard. They complain, "Who can accept this?" Jesus knows what they are thinking. He tells them that his words are spirit and life. But some of them do not believe in him.

From that moment, many disciples go away and stop following him. So Jesus asks the Twelve if they want to leave too. Simon Peter answers him: "Master, to whom shall we go? You have the words of eternal life." And he adds that they believe and know that Jesus is the Holy One of God.

What Jesus Tells Us: Even when something is hard to understand, we can trust Jesus and stay with him, like Peter.



Color Saint Peter with his keys, his net, and his fishing boat.

My Question

What helps you stay Jesus' friend, even when it is hard?

This Week as a Family

Every evening this week, say a little prayer of trust together: "Jesus, I am staying with you."

Sunday, August 29, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-second Sunday in Ordinary Time

What Comes From the Heart

Gospel: Mark 7:1-8, 14-15, 21-23

The Gospel Told for Kids

Some Pharisees and scribes see Jesus' disciples eating without washing their hands. For them, this is very important: they follow the tradition of the elders, and they also wash their cups and jugs. They ask Jesus why his disciples do not do the same. Jesus answers with words of the prophet Isaiah: these people praise God with their words, but their hearts are far away from him.

Then Jesus calls the crowd and says: "Nothing that enters one from outside can defile that person; but the things that come out from within are what defile." To defile means to make someone unclean inside, far from God. What counts is what comes out of the heart. Bad thoughts and wrong things come from the heart: stealing, being mean, being jealous, being proud... That is what makes a person unclean.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus looks at our hearts: he teaches us to keep them clean, full of love and kindness.



Color Jesus, with the heart on his chest, and the children around him.

My Question

What good thing would you like to bring out of your heart this week?

This Week as a Family

In the evening, ask each other: "What good thing came out of my heart today?"

Sunday, September 5, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Ephphatha: Be Opened!

Gospel: Mark 7:31-37

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is walking toward the Sea of Galilee. Some people bring him a man who is deaf and can hardly speak. They beg Jesus to lay his hand on him. Jesus takes the man aside, away from the crowd. He puts his fingers into the man's ears and touches his tongue.

Then Jesus looks up to heaven, sighs, and says: "'Ephphatha!' (that is, 'Be opened!')" At once the man's ears are opened, his tongue is set free, and he speaks clearly. Jesus tells the people not to tell anyone, but the more he asks, the more they talk about it. Amazed, they say that he does everything well: he helps deaf people hear and people who cannot talk speak!

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus opens our ears to listen to God's Word, and our mouths to share it with others.



Color Jesus healing the deaf man, and the little village behind them.

My Question

How can you open your ears wide to listen well to Jesus at Mass?

This Week as a Family

During a meal, each person tells about a moment from the day, and the others listen without interrupting.

Sunday, September 12, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Who Is Jesus for You?

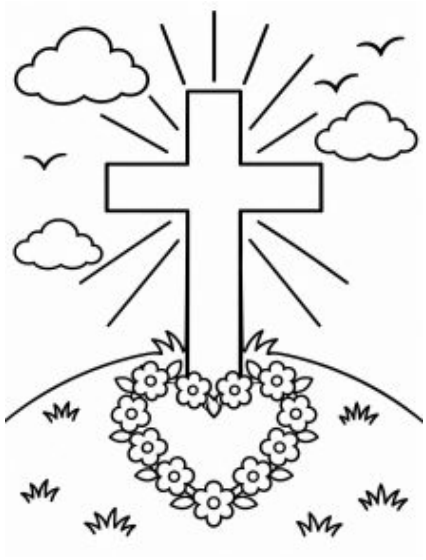
Gospel: Mark 8:27-35

The Gospel Told for Kids

On the road, Jesus asks his disciples what people say about him. They answer: some say John the Baptist, others Elijah, others one of the prophets. Then Jesus asks them: "But who do you say that I am?" Peter answers that Jesus is the Messiah, the one God has sent.

Then Jesus explains that he will suffer a lot, that he will be rejected and put to death, and that after three days he will rise again. Peter does not agree and takes him aside to scold him. But Jesus tells him that he is not thinking the way God thinks. Then he tells the crowd: whoever wants to follow him must stop putting himself first, take up his cross, and walk behind him.

What Jesus Tells Us: Following Jesus means knowing him, loving him, and walking with him, even when it is hard.



Color the cross, the flowers, and the sun: Jesus invites us to follow him.

My Question

If Jesus asked you who he is for you, what would you answer?

This Week as a Family

Each person says in one sentence who Jesus is for them, then everyone makes the Sign of the Cross together.

Sunday, September 19, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-fifth Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Greatest Is the One Who Serves

Gospel: Mark 9:30-37

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is traveling through Galilee with his disciples. He tells them that he will be handed over, that he will be put to death, and that three days later he will rise. The disciples do not understand, and they are afraid to ask him questions. On the way, they argue about which of them is the greatest.

When they reach the house in Capernaum, Jesus asks them what they were talking about. They stay quiet. So Jesus sits down, calls the Twelve, and says to them: "If anyone wishes to be first, he shall be the last of all and the servant of all." Then he takes a child, places the child in the middle of them, and hugs the child. Whoever welcomes a child like this in his name, he says, welcomes him.

What Jesus Tells Us: For Jesus, being great means serving others and welcoming children.



Color Jesus welcoming the children close to him.

My Question

Whom can you help this week, at home or at school?

_____

_____

_____

This Week as a Family

Many parishes celebrate Catechetical Sunday today and pray for their catechists. Each of you can choose a small way to help someone in the family this week.

Sunday, September 26, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-sixth Sunday in Ordinary Time

A Simple Cup of Water

Gospel: Mark 9:38-43, 45, 47-48

The Gospel Told for Kids

John, one of the Twelve, says to Jesus, "We saw a man driving out evil spirits in your name, and we tried to stop him because he is not one of us." Jesus answers, "Do not stop him. Anyone who is not against us is on our side." And he adds: "Anyone who gives you a cup of water to drink because you belong to Christ, amen, I say to you, will surely not lose his reward."

Then Jesus uses very strong words. Leading one of the little ones who believe in him into sin is very serious. He says that if your hand leads you to do wrong, it would be better to lose it, and he says the same about the foot and the eye. It is a strong comparison to help us understand that nothing must take us away from God: it is better to give up everything than to lose our life with him.

What Jesus Tells Us: Nothing is more precious than staying God's friend, and for him, even the smallest act of kindness counts.



Color the children helping an elderly lady: every act of kindness counts for Jesus.

My Question

What small act of kindness, like giving a cup of water, can you do this week?

This Week as a Family

This week, offer a drink or a small favor to someone who often helps you: a neighbor, a crossing guard, a friend.

Sunday, October 3, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-seventh Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Blesses the Children

Gospel: Mark 10:2-16

The Gospel Told for Kids

Some Pharisees want to test Jesus. They ask him if a husband is allowed to send his wife away. Jesus reminds them that in the beginning, God made man and woman. When they marry, they leave their parents and become one. Then Jesus says that no one should pull apart what God has joined.

Later, people bring children to Jesus so that he will touch them. But the disciples push them away. Jesus is upset and says: "Let the children come to me; do not prevent them, for the kingdom of God belongs to such as these." Then he takes the children in his arms and blesses them, placing his hands on them.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus loves every family and every child: you can always come to him with trust.



Color Jesus surrounded by the children he is blessing.

My Question

What would you like to say to Jesus if you were sitting right next to him?

This Week as a Family

Tonight, bless your children by tracing a small cross on their foreheads, and pray for the whole family.

Sunday, October 10, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-eighth Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Real Treasure

Gospel: Mark 10:17-30

The Gospel Told for Kids

A man runs up to Jesus, kneels down, and asks him what he must do to have eternal life. Jesus reminds him of the commandments: do not steal, do not lie, honor your father and your mother... The man has kept them since he was young. Jesus looks at him and loves him. He tells him there is still one thing to do: sell everything he owns, give the money to the poor, and then come and follow him. That way he will have a treasure in heaven.

But the man becomes sad and goes away, because he owns many things. Jesus tells his disciples that a camel could more easily go through the eye of a needle than a rich person get into the kingdom of God. The disciples are amazed. Jesus looks at them and says: "For human beings it is impossible, but not for God. All things are possible for God."

What Jesus Tells Us: The greatest treasure is to follow Jesus and to share with those who need it.



Color the man kneeling in front of Jesus, the poor family, and the little camel.

My Question

What could you share with someone who needs it?

This Week as a Family

Together, choose a toy or a piece of clothing in good condition and give it to a charity.

Sunday, October 17, 2027 Color: green

Twenty-ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Came to Serve

Gospel: Mark 10:35-45

The Gospel Told for Kids

James and John, two of the disciples, ask Jesus if they can sit one at his right and the other at his left in his glory. Jesus answers that they do not know what they are asking. He asks them if they can drink the cup that he will drink. They say yes. But Jesus explains that it is not up to him to give those places.

The other ten disciples get angry with James and John. So Jesus calls them all together. He explains that in the world, rulers boss people around. But among them it must not be like that: whoever wants to be great will be the servant of the others. And Jesus says: "For the Son of Man did not come to be served but to serve and to give his life as a ransom for many." A ransom is the price paid to set someone free.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus gave his life for us. We too can give a little of ourselves by serving others.



Color Jesus washing his friends' feet: he came to serve.

My Question

How can you serve someone this week without expecting anything in return?

This Week as a Family

One evening this week, the children serve dinner and the parents let themselves be served.

Sunday, October 24, 2027 Color: green

Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Bartimaeus Can See Again

Gospel: Mark 10:46-52

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is leaving the town of Jericho with his disciples and a large crowd. By the side of the road sits Bartimaeus, a blind man who begs. When he hears that it is Jesus passing by, he starts to shout and asks Jesus to have pity on him. Many people tell him to be quiet. But he shouts even louder.

Jesus stops and asks them to call him. The people tell the blind man, "Cheer up! Stand up, Jesus wants you!" Bartimaeus throws off his cloak, jumps up, and goes to Jesus. Jesus asks him what he wants. He answers that he wants to see again. Jesus tells him: "Go your way; your faith has saved you." At once Bartimaeus can see, and he follows Jesus on the way.

What Jesus Tells Us: Like Bartimaeus, we can call on Jesus with trust: he stops to listen to us.



Color Bartimaeus, with his cloak on the ground, full of joy in front of Jesus.

My Question

What would you like to ask Jesus with trust, like Bartimaeus?

This Week as a Family

Learn a short prayer together, "Jesus, have mercy on me," and say it every evening this week.

Sunday, October 31, 2027 Color: green

Thirty-first Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Greatest Commandment

Gospel: Mark 12:28b-34

The Gospel Told for Kids

A scribe, a man who knows God's Law well, asks Jesus which commandment is the first of all. Jesus answers, "Listen, Israel! The Lord our God is the only Lord." We must love God with our whole heart, our whole soul, our whole mind, and all our strength.

Then Jesus goes on: "The second is this: 'You shall love your neighbor as yourself.' There is no other commandment greater than these." The scribe agrees: loving God and loving others is worth more than all the offerings. Jesus sees that he has understood well and tells him that he is not far from the kingdom of God.

What Jesus Tells Us: Love God and love others: these are the two most important commandments.



Color Jesus and the children sharing bread around him.

My Question

How can you show your love for God, and for others, this week?

This Week as a Family

Draw a big heart on a sheet of paper: each evening, write inside it one act of love you did that day.

Monday, November 1, 2027 Color: white

All Saints' Day

The Paths to Happiness

Gospel: Matthew 5:1-12a

The Gospel Told for Kids

When he sees the crowds, Jesus goes up the mountain. He sits down, and his disciples come close to him. Then he begins to teach them. He tells them who is truly happy, or blessed: those who are poor in spirit, because the kingdom of heaven is theirs. Those who are sad, because God will comfort them. The gentle, because the earth will be given to them.

Happy also are those who hunger and thirst for what is right, those who show mercy, and those whose hearts are pure, because one day they will see God face to face. Happy are those who make peace: God will call them his children. Even those who are treated badly because of Jesus are happy. He tells them: "Rejoice and be glad, for your reward will be great in heaven."

What Jesus Tells Us: The saints followed these paths to happiness. We too are called to become saints!



Color Jesus sitting on the mountain, teaching the crowd near the lake.

My Question

Which path to happiness do you want to try this week: being gentle, making peace, comforting someone...?

This Week as a Family

Together, look up the saint each of you is named after, and tell the children about him or her.

Sunday, November 7, 2027 Color: green

Thirty-second Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Poor Widow's Gift

Gospel: Mark 12:38-44

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus is teaching the crowd. He tells them to watch out for the scribes who like fine robes, being greeted in the marketplace, and the best seats. They take what belongs to widows and say long prayers so that people will see them. Then Jesus sits down in the Temple, across from the treasury, and watches people putting in money.

Many rich people put in large amounts. Then a poor widow comes, a woman whose husband has died: she puts in just two small coins. Jesus calls his disciples and says to them: "Amen, I say to you, this poor widow put in more than all the other contributors to the treasury." The others give from what they have left over. She gives everything she has to live on.

What Jesus Tells Us: God does not look at the size of the gift, but at the heart of the giver: the widow gives everything.



Color the poor widow giving her two small coins, and Jesus watching her.

My Question

What can you give with your whole heart: your time, your smile, your help?

This Week as a Family

At the collection during Mass, let the children put in the family's offering themselves.

Sunday, November 14, 2027 Color: green

Thirty-third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Jesus Will Come Again

Gospel: Mark 13:24-32

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus talks to his disciples about the day when he will come back. After hard times, the sun and the moon will stop shining and the stars will fall from the sky. Then people will see Jesus coming on the clouds, full of power and glory. He will send his angels to gather the people he has chosen from the four corners of the world.

Jesus gives an example: when the fig tree's branches get soft and new leaves appear, we know summer is coming. In the same way, when all this happens, Jesus will be very near, at the door. He says: "Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away." No one knows the day or the hour, only the Father.

What Jesus Tells Us: We are not afraid: Jesus will come again, and his words will never pass away. We wait for him with trust.



Color the tree full of leaves and fruit: it reminds us of the fig tree Jesus talks about.

My Question

Which words of Jesus would you like to keep in your heart forever?

This Week as a Family

Together, choose some words of Jesus, write them in big letters, and put them up in your home.

Sunday, November 21, 2027 Color: white

Our Lord Jesus Christ, King of the Universe (Christ the King)

A King Like No Other

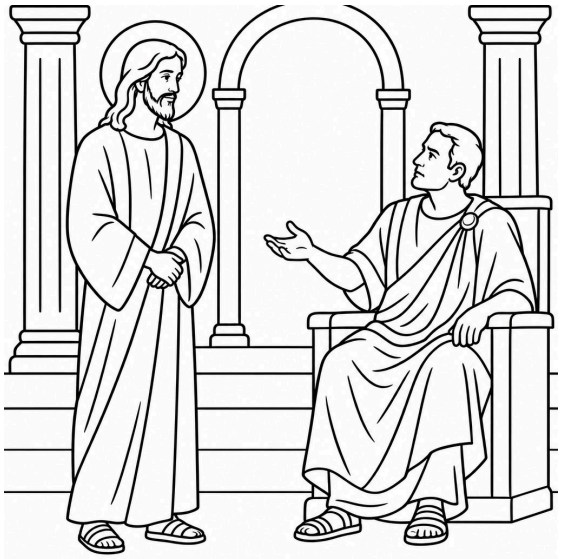
Gospel: John 18:33b-37

The Gospel Told for Kids

Jesus has been handed over to Pilate, the Roman governor. Pilate asks him if he is the King of the Jews. Jesus asks him in return if this is his own idea, or if other people told him. Pilate answers that it was Jesus' own people and the chief priests who handed him over, and he wants to know what Jesus has done.

Jesus explains: "My kingdom does not belong to this world. ..." If it did, his helpers would fight to defend him. Pilate insists, "So you are a king?" Jesus answers that it is Pilate who says so. Jesus says that he was born and came into the world to be a witness to the truth. And everyone who is on the side of the truth hears his voice.

What Jesus Tells Us: Jesus is a King of love and truth. He does not rule with soldiers, but in our hearts.



Color Jesus, calm and trusting, in front of Pilate seated in his palace.

My Question

How can you listen to the voice of Jesus, the King of your heart?

This Week as a Family

This week, try to always tell the truth, even when it is hard. On Thanksgiving, thank God together for Jesus, our King.